

Data Brokers and Location



BIG IDEA *Small pieces of information that are harmless alone can be combined into a detailed picture of you. You decide how many pieces you hand out and how precise they are. What you share can travel and stay.*

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: R4 Profile Fragment Cards for the fictional teen Jordan (6 to 8 per group of 3 to 4) and the Settings Mock-up page, Workbook W4, pens.

- ☐ Print the R4 fragment sets and Settings Mock-up page.
- ☐ Never show a student's real device. Run no people-search or data-broker lookup on anyone in class.
- ☐ Write the Defense Plan line for the takeaway on the board.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Say: "Jordan is made up. A friend posted a photo of Jordan in a school hoodie. Jordan's fitness app shows a running route that starts at the same spot every morning. A game screenshot has a street sign in the background. A birthday post says 'sweet sixteen today.' Any one of those is nothing. Together, they are a map to where Jordan lives and when Jordan is out. That is the mosaic effect, and it is what companies that buy and sell data do at scale. Today you assemble Jordan's mosaic, and then you take pieces out."

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Mosaic and Settings Check*

- 1 (3 min) Build the mosaic.** Lay out the fragments. On W4 write what a stranger could infer (school or area, routine, approximate home, age, friends, when the house might be empty). Ask "what could be known?" and write each inference beside the fragment that led to it.
- 2 (2 min) Break the chain.** Which one fragment, removed or changed, breaks the most inferences? Then which setting or habit changes it: a privacy zone in the fitness app, no photo location tag, precise location off, asking a friend not to tag where you are right now, posting after you have left.
- 3 (2 min) Settings check** on the Mock-up. Mark location Never, While using or Always for each app. Where is Precise needed (maps), and where does approximate do (weather)? Match each permission to the need.
- 4 (1 min) Data brokers.** Apps collect location and device IDs, and data brokers gather or buy information to build and sell profiles. Rights vary by state and many opt-outs need an adult. Realistic move for a teen: reduce what you hand out now and ask a parent or guardian to help with opt-outs.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** "What is the difference between 'private' and 'hard to find'? Which would you rather have?"
- 2** "A friend posts a photo of you without asking. What can you say in one sentence?"
- 3** "Who benefits when an app asks for 'always on' location? How would you decide?"

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN "Pause before posting a place, a time or a background. Check the setting: who sees it, how precise, how long? Tell a trusted adult if someone shows they know where you are and you did not tell them. Add to your Defense Plan: 'One piece I will take out of my mosaic is ____.'"

Hand signal: Hackles up? Someone who knows where you are, and you never told them, is a signal (hand brushed up the neck, optional). Post it: "Pieces, not secrets, give you away."

EXIT TICKET "Name one piece of your own (or Jordan's) mosaic you would remove, and the setting or habit that removes it."

FUN BOOST Smallest Fix Challenge. Groups find the fewest removals that break all six inferences on W4. Fewer, smarter changes win.

LEVEL-UP Persona Audit. Audit a fictional persona's mosaic, then set a 90-day settings review with an adult.

DIFFERENTIATE Give a pre-filled mosaic with some inferences written in; students complete the "break the chain" column. Use picture cards.

FAMILY CARD Ask: "What is one thing you could change in an app's location or photo settings?" Check one location setting together. Agree on a location-sharing rule that is mutual and open.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- Say:** "Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing."
- "This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble."
- "I can't keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who."
- Do not say:** "Why did you post it?" or "How could you...?"
- "I won't tell anyone."
- "You should have told someone sooner."

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state's reporting law.